

Hackathon Readiness Checklist

Planning items to confirm together ahead of the event

Planning Checklist

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Confirm dates

Event days and times.

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Confirm room / venue

Space and capacity at the customer location.

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Confirm audio / video

AV setup, screen sharing, recording.

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Confirm power / electricity

Enough outlets and power strips for every laptop.

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Confirm food

Meals and breaks.

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Confirm Wi-Fi / network access

Guest network capacity for all laptops; access to GitHub/Copilot endpoints (firewall/proxy).

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Confirm prerequisites / environment setup

GitHub access, Copilot licenses active, required tools installed before arrival.

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Confirm on-site point of contact

Facilities/host contact, building hours, and after-hours access.

☐

Confirm leadership involvement

Kick off the event and be available during Day 2 readouts.



Define how virtual teams work

How remote participants join and collaborate (see suggestions).



Distribute problem-statement deck

Share with teams to prepare and submit.



Confirm visitor check-in

Guest/badge process at the customer location.



Decide awards & judging criteria (optional)

Prizes for top teams and how winners are selected.



Finalize participant count

Final number of attendees.



Send Teams invitation to participants

Calendar invite with event details and join link.



Define how teams are formed

Pre-formed vs day-of.



Confirm Day 2 hacking projects

Should be developer-work related (see suggestions).

Suggestions

These are options for you to decide — not requirements.

Virtual teams

- One persistent virtual room per team; in-person members also join from their laptops so everyone collaborates digitally.
- A dedicated facilitator for virtual teams.
- Readouts presented via screen-share so remote teams aren't disadvantaged.

Readout formats for groups over 100

A single readout per team works well up to ~100 people. For larger groups, use one of these:

- **Heats → Finals** — split teams into parallel pods/rooms, each with its own judges; each pod sends 1–2 finalists to present to the full room.
- **Track-based readouts** — group teams by theme (e.g., tech-debt, developer productivity); each track runs its own readout and only track winners present on the main stage.

How to choose Day 2 hacking projects

You decide these. Suggested sources for developer-work-related projects:

- Engineering managers nominate candidate projects.
- Tech-debt items.
- Backlog / sprint items.
- Developer-productivity improvements.

Agenda

Day 1 — Modules & Labs (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM)

Time	Duration	Activity
9:00 – 9:15	15 min	Welcome & Kickoff
9:15 – 10:45	90 min	Module 1: Foundations (presentation + lab)
10:45 – 11:00	15 min	☕ Break
11:00 – 12:55	115 min	Module 2: Agentic Patterns (presentation + lab)
12:55 – 1:40	45 min	🍽️ Lunch
1:40 – 3:10	90 min	Module 3: Advanced Topics (presentation + lab)
3:10 – 3:25	15 min	☕ Break
3:25 – 4:45	80 min	Open Lab / Hack Prep
4:45 – 5:00	15 min	Day 1 Wrap-up & Day 2 Preview

Day 2 — Hack Day (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM)

Time	Duration	Activity
9:00 – 9:15	15 min	Day 2 Kickoff & Team Formation

Time	Duration	Activity
9:15 – 12:00	165 min	 Hack — Build with Copilot
12:00 – 12:45	45 min	 Lunch
12:45 – 3:00	135 min	 Hack — Continue Building
3:00 – 4:30	90 min	 Project Readouts
4:30 – 5:00	30 min	Wrap-up & Next Steps